

► PPSH-41

Date 1939

Origin Soviet Union

Weight 3.5kg (7¾lb)

Barrel 27cm (10½in)

Calibre 7.62mm

Over five million examples of this sturdy and dependable weapon had been manufactured for the Red Army by the end of World War II.



Rear sight adjustable for windage and elevation



Retractable skeleton butt



Cocking-handle cover acts as safety catch

Flash suppressor

▲ M3A1

Date 1940s

Origin US

Weight 3.66kg (8lb)

Barrel 20.3cm (8in)

Calibre .45in ACP

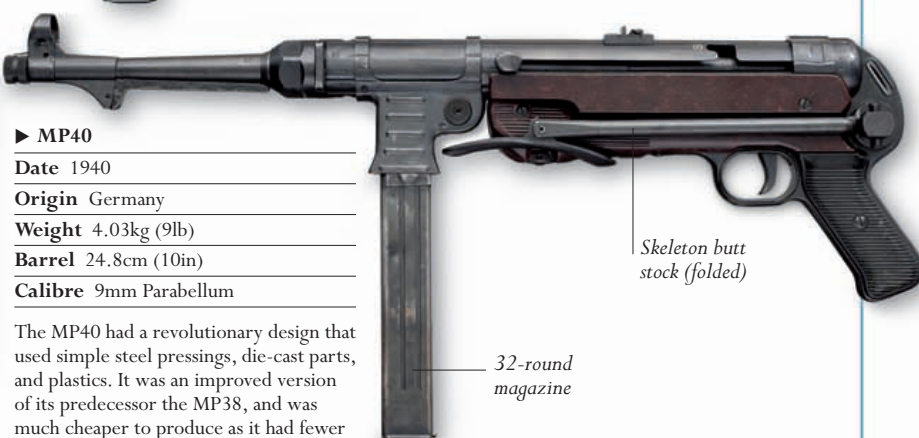
The M3 "Grease Gun" – and the improved M3A1 version – was cheap to produce and simple to strip, clean, and maintain. It fired the same heavy pistol round used in the Colt M1911A1.

Carrying sling

30-round detachable box magazine



Wooden butt stock, removable in some models



► MP40

Date 1940

Origin Germany

Weight 4.03kg (9lb)

Barrel 24.8cm (10in)

Calibre 9mm Parabellum

The MP40 had a revolutionary design that used simple steel pressings, die-cast parts, and plastics. It was an improved version of its predecessor the MP38, and was much cheaper to produce as it had fewer machined parts.

Skeleton butt stock (folded)

32-round magazine



Rear sight

Fixed steel butt stock



▲ STEN MARK II

Date 1941

Origin UK

Weight 3.7kg (8¼lb)

Barrel 19.7cm (7¾in)

Calibre 9mm

Cheap and easy to manufacture, the Sten was a stop-gap weapon that was to prove itself an effective submachine-gun. The gun was fitted with a 32-round magazine.

Butt houses 13-round removable magazine



▲ BERETTA MODELLO 1938/42

Date 1942

Origin Italy

Weight 3.27kg (7¼lb)

Barrel 21.3cm (8½in)

Calibre 9mm

One of the finest weapons of its type to see service during World War II, the M38/42 was well-made, reliable, and, for a submachine-gun, surprisingly accurate.

High-quality wooden stock

Double trigger for automatic and single-shot fire

Extended 40-round magazine